

Katrin Rohrbacher

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Research Areas

Computational Literary Studies, Computational Narratology, NLP, Large Language Models, Digital Humanities Infrastructure

Research Positions

03/2025–	Research Associate (Postdoc) , Text and Language Lab (Prof. Michaela Mahlberg), Department of Digital Humanities and Social Studies, Friedrich-Alexander-Universität Erlangen-Nürnberg
2021–2022	Researcher and Project Manager , PIVOT (PI: Prof. Dror Etzion), McGill University
11/2015– 02/2018	Student Research Assistant , Institute for Corpus Linguistics and Text Technology (ICLTT), Austrian Academy of Sciences

Education

2018–02/2025	PhD , German Studies, Department of Languages, Literatures, and Cultures, McGill University Dissertation: <i>Aspects of Space: Quantitative Approaches to Fictional Worlds</i> . Supervisor: Prof. Andrew Piper
2014–2018	MA , Department of Comparative Literature, University of Vienna
2010–2014	BA , Department of Comparative Literature, University of Vienna

Publications

DOCTORAL DISSERTATION

Rohrbacher, K. (2025). *Aspects of Space: Quantitative Approaches to Fictional Worlds*. Doctoral dissertation, McGill University. eScholarship@McGill.

JOURNAL AND CONFERENCE PUBLICATIONS (PEER-REVIEWED)

Rohrbacher, K., Nieth, B., Salin, E., Eskofier, B. & Mahlberg, M. (2026). How LLMs Build Fictional Worlds: Setting and Narrative Space in AI-Generated Creative Storytelling. *Proceedings of the 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*. Accepted for the main conference. Preprint: <https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2609.02482>

Rohrbacher, K. & Schrittemser, D. (2026). Bridging the Gaps: Integrating Bibliographic Metadata into Wikidata for Literary Corpora. *Journal of Open Humanities Data*, 12(1), 37. <https://doi.org/10.5334/johd.483>

Rohrbacher, K. (2026). “Lived Space”: A Computational Study of Setting in Fiction. In B. Herrmann, G. Grisot & R. Aust (eds.), *Comparing Landscapes: Approaches to Space and Affect in Literary Fiction*. Bielefeld University Press. Forthcoming (accepted).

Rohrbacher, K., Wagner, A. & Mahlberg, M. (2026). “Letting the Cat out of the Bag”: Towards the Automatic Detection of Animal Metaphors in Literary Texts. *Book of Abstracts of DH2026*, ADHO Annual Conference, South Korea/hybrid, pp.~685–688. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.21495909>

Rohrbacher, K. (2025). de-Corp: A Corpus of German-language Fiction and Non-Fiction (1780–1930). *Journal of Open Humanities Data*, 11(1), 51. <https://doi.org/10.5334/johd.350>

Rohrbacher, K. (2025). Opening Worlds: Narrative Beginnings and the Role of Setting. *CCLS2025 Conference Preprints*, 4(1). Peer-reviewed and accepted for the 4th Annual Conference on Computational Literary Studies, Kraków 2025. Extended version in revision for the *Journal of Computational Literary Studies*. <https://doi.org/10.26083/tuprints-00030149>

Luederitz, C., Animesh, A., **Rohrbacher, K.**, Li, T., Piper, A., Potvin, C. & Etzion, D. (2023). Non-monetary narratives motivate businesses to engage with climate change. *Sustainability Science*, 18(6), 2649–2660. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11625-023-01386-1>

BOOK CHAPTERS AND REFERENCE WORKS (PEER-REVIEWED)

Mahlberg, M. & **Rohrbacher, K.** (2026). Corpora in Digital Humanities and Corpus Linguistics. In H. Nesi & P. Milin (eds.), *International Encyclopedia of Language and Linguistics* (3rd ed., pp.~62–68). Elsevier. <https://doi.org/10.1016/B978-0-323-95504-1.01548-9>

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION (INVITED CONTRIBUTIONS)

Mahlberg, M. & **Rohrbacher, K.** (in preparation). [Title to be confirmed]. In *The Oxford Handbook of Language and Masculinities*. Invited contribution, under contract.

Funding and Fellowships Awarded

Period	Funding	Amount
08/2026– 08/2027	FAU Emerging Talents Initiative (ETI) , “Nature in Motion: A Computational Study of Environmental Representation in Travel Writing” (applicant, awarded).	€15,000
2026	Travel Grant , Office for Gender and Diversity, FAU Erlangen-Nürnberg (awarded)	€500
01/2021– 02/2022	Graduate Fellowship , Wolfe Chair for Science and Technology, McGill University	€5,100*
	Total funding acquired	€20,600

*converted from CAD 7,500

Honors and Awards

12/2021	Hans Walter Frischkopf Award for Excellence in Teaching, McGill University
01/2020	Graduate Excellence Award , McGill University
01/2019	Graduate Excellence Award , McGill University

Research Data, Software and Resources

2026	Reproducible pipeline for importing literary metadata into Wikidata (with D. Schrittester). Documented in https://doi.org/10.5334/johd.483
2026	Classifier for the automatic detection of animal metaphors (English). https://huggingface.co/katrohrb/animal-metaphor-classifier
2025–2026	Transformer classifiers for the detection of spatial and setting categories (German and English), with annotation guidelines. https://huggingface.co/katrohrb/de-setting-classifier , https://huggingface.co/katrohrb/narrative-space-classifier
2025	de-Corp , German-language literary corpus (1780–1930). https://zenodo.org/records/15714828 ; documented in https://doi.org/10.5334/johd.350

Academic Service

since 09/2026	Representative of the mid-level academic staff (PhD students and PostDocs), Department of Digital Humanities and Social Studies, FAU Erlangen-Nuremberg
04/2025–09/2026	Deputy Representative of the mid-level academic staff, Department of Digital Humanities and Social Studies, FAU Erlangen-Nuremberg

Conference and Workshop Organization

09/2025	Co-Organizer , DHSS Summer School “Data, Gender, and Society”, FAU Erlangen-Nuremberg
01/2022	Co-Organizer , “7th Annual German Teaching Workshop”, McGill University
03/2021	Co-Organizer , Graduate Research Conference, “Environment: Last Call”, McGill University

Editorial Work, Peer Review and Memberships

2019–2025	Managing Editor , Journal of Cultural Analytics, https://culturalanalytics.org Peer review , DHd, Journal of Computational Literary Studies Memberships , ADHO, COMPTExT, ACL
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Teaching

Friedrich-Alexander-Universität Erlangen-Nürnberg, Department of Digital Humanities and Social Studies

Summer 2026 **DH 1: Sprache und Text** (Digital Humanities 1: Language and Text).
Seminar with lab component
Summer 2026 **Critical AI**. Seminar
Winter
2025/26 **Computational Approaches to Storytelling**. Seminar

McGill University, Montreal, Department of Languages, Literatures and Cultures

Winter 2024 **Modern Short Fiction**. Seminar, taught in English
Winter 2023 **The German Novel**. Seminar, taught in English
2018–2024 **German as a Foreign Language**, beginner and intermediate level

Other Professional Experience

2017–2018 **Curatorial Assistant**, Halle für Kunst Steiermark, <https://halle-fuer-kunst.at/>

Invited Talks

01/2026 *Measuring Narrative Space: A Computational Study of German and English Prose Fiction*, University of Bielefeld, Kolloquium Literaturwissenschaften Revisited
11/2025 *Aspects of Space: Quantitative Evidence and Fictional Worlds*, University of Hamburg, DH Lecture Series

Talks and Workshops (selected)

07/2026 **Talk**, ADHO Annual Conference 2026, South Korea, "Towards the Automatic Detection of Animal Metaphors in Literary Texts"
04/2026 **Talk**, 8th annual COMPTExT conference, University of Birmingham, "Modeling Embodiment in Narratives"
09/2025 **Workshop**, FAU-Erlangen Nuremberg, DHSS Summer School, "Who is Doing What to Whom: Analyzing Gender Biases in Large Language Models"
07/2025 **Talk**, Conference of Computational Literary Studies, University of Krakow, "Opening Worlds: Narrative Beginnings and the role of Setting"
03/2024 **Talk**, AACL Montreal, "Questions of Authorship and Agency in the Age of Machine Learning"
10/2023 **Talk**, "A Computational Study of Setting in German Fiction, GSA Montreal"

Supervision

- since 11/2026 **Supervision** of a student research assistant in corpus construction and annotation (ETI project "Nature in Motion"), FAU Erlangen-Nuremberg
- since 09/2025 **Supervision** of a student research assistant, Text and Language Lab, FAU Erlangen-Nuremberg. Statistical analysis and corpus construction
- 06/2025-06/2026 **Co-adviser**, MA-thesis, Marius Lin, "Framing of Political Discourse in Online Forums", FAU Erlangen-Nuremberg
- 03/2025-03/2026 **Co-adviser**, MA-thesis, Jan-Oliver Reincke, "Climate Change Narratives in Video Game Storytelling: A Text-Based Computational Study of Emotion", FAU Erlangen-Nuremberg

Methods and Technical Skills

Computational analysis, Python, NLP and machine learning, large language models

Corpus and data work, corpus construction and curation, annotation guidelines, text recognition (print and manuscript)

Research infrastructure, Linked Open Data (Wikidata, Wikibase), reproducible pipelines, open-source tool development

Language Skills

German (native), English (fluent), French (intermediate)